

rential approach must be followed for a digital platform to be successful. This focuses on people who will use the digital platform—whether they are customers, employees or other ecosystem partners. The need or utility of the platform will differ according to type of users, their responsibilities and the tasks for which they use the platform.

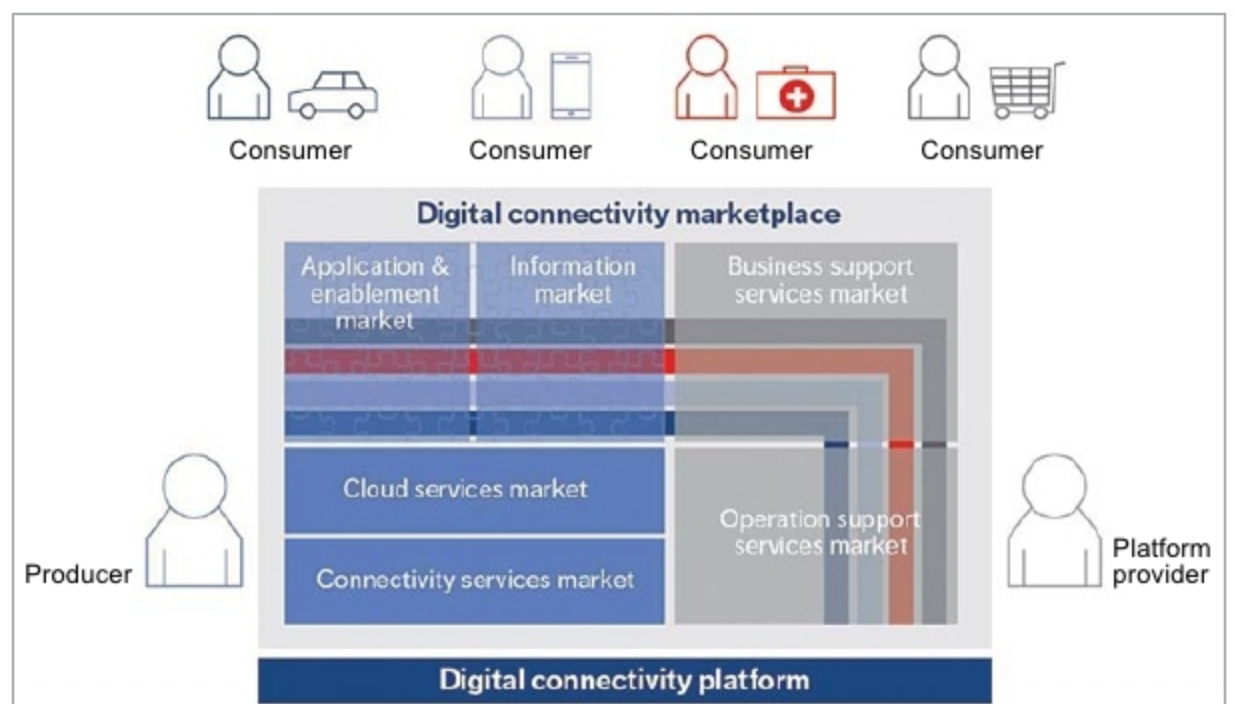
Thus, the first step in the experiential approach to building or assembling a digital platform is to identify the needs of various types of users, because that is the experience that the platform must deliver; otherwise, they would not adopt/use it.

The second step is to establish metrics, which is a way to measure whether the platform delivers that experience (business objective) in a timely fashion. Two typical ways to measure user experience are completeness of the job and time it takes to complete it. Companies need to design their digital platform around delivering important experiences for each type of user and finding the appropriate metrics. They should then select technologies that will support those experiences and metrics.

There are many calls to regulate digital platforms. Motivations behind regulations include exploitation of workers, dangerous content (such as fake news), data security and privacy, and national or regional competitiveness. Any new regulations should be narrowly-tailored to deal with specific problems as they occur, such as addressing copyright infringement.

Applications and prospects

Digital platforms are required by different business models such as advertising, information, e-commerce and pay-per-service. Platforms required for these business models are media platforms such as Gaana and Netflix; collaboration platforms such as Slack, WhatsApp and Skype; search engine platforms such as Google and Bing; social platforms such as Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, LinkedIn and Pinterest; knowledge platforms such as Byju's; e-commerce platforms such as Shopify and Amazon; online marketplaces such as Apple Store and Google Play; service exchange platforms such as Uber and MakeMyTrip; cloud platforms as a service (PaaS) such as



Digital connectivity marketplace (Credit: www.ericsson.com)

Microsoft Azure; infrastructure as a service (IaaS) such as Amazon S3; and database as a service (DBaaS) such as Amazon RDS and Microsoft Azure DocumentDB.

Digital platforms allow a company to provide an e-commerce platform for consumers to purchase from third-party sellers. More recent surges of innovation around digital platforms and their emphasis on customers have been driven by three transformative technologies, namely, cloud computing providing a global infrastructure, social networks connecting people and mobile devices providing accessibility from anywhere.

Evolution of a platform-enabled economy has resulted in a globally-accessible network of contributing content, developing applications, building businesses, and purchasing goods and services.

Digital platforms for IoT applications

The Internet of Things (IoT) platforms have become an essential part of the IoT stack to manage, monitor, store, secure and analyse IoT data. These play a role in security, and need to be scalable and flexible to respond to customer needs, use-case demands and goals that vary depending on the use-case. This enables device monitoring and management, data acquisition, IoT application programming, security, and firmware updates, visualisation, analytics and adapters to connect to enterprise systems.

An IoT platform is the logical evo-

lution of the IoT, in combination with other technologies. It focuses on levels of connectivity and connected devices to Edge applications. An IoT platform enables solutions within several use-cases and services. It provides Edge-to-cloud solutions to connect, monitor and manage energy and assets at infrastructures remotely.

Alois Kliner, head of division digital enterprise security, G + D Mobile Security, says, "We are living in an extraordinary era; a time that is defined by connectivity and interconnected things. This ever-growing connectivity requires a powerful infrastructure that can address the needs presented by its users. Platforms at the core of this infrastructure are responsible for intricate management and connectivity of all connected devices."

IoT platforms enable a secure connection between devices, and handle everything between networks, access points, hardware and applications. These are generally divided into three main types: application enablement/development platforms (AEPs/ADPs), data/network/subscriber management platforms and device management platforms (DMP).

AEPs provide foundational services that include application-making and enabling device management and communication, security, database, analytics and external interfaces.

Role of digital platforms to provide connectivity

The digital connectivity marketplace provides capabilities to exchange